budget has kept the growing inflationary pressure in mind, which could have been a by-product of the recovery process—this is happening across the advanced countries right now. In my view, given the resource constraints and with growing public debt concerns, the budget has ensured a fine balance between growth aspirations and fiscal challenges and these measures should help provide a medium-term growth push.

> "Beyond spending by the government, a full economic recovery hinges on factors like Covid, crude oil prices and the global economic outlook"
>
> – DHARMAKIRTI JOSHI

● **ADITI NAYAR:** We do believe that higher capex can kickstart a durable growth recovery. However, the higher government borrowing programme has hardened G-sec yields. With inflation likely to remain elevated in FY2023, the repo rate as well as market interest rates are set to rise, which may pose a challenge to some categories of borrowers.

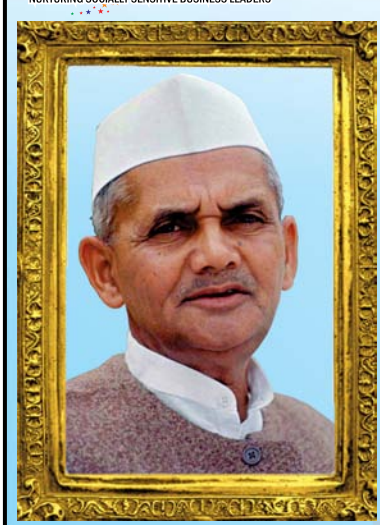
● **DHARMAKIRTI JOSHI:** This is clearly an expansionary budget. The government has created the fiscal space to address spending needs by delaying the fiscal consolidation process, and rightly so. The fiscal deficit is expected to come down to 4.5 per cent of gross domestic product (GDP) by fiscal 2026, still higher than the pre-pandemic level of 3.3 per cent. Also, the revenue expenditure has been compressed to make way for capital spending.

Spending has been largely prioritised towards investments, with some part focusing on supporting vulnerable sections. It is more of a growth-promoting budget than a redistributive one.

Beyond spending by the government, full economic recovery hinges on how certain factors play out, including Covid-19, crude oil prices and the global economic outlook. We are projecting 7.8 per cent GDP growth next fiscal, with risks tilted downwards. ■


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